MIL-STD-397
26 September 1977

MILITARY STANDARD

NATO SYMBOL OF INTERCHANGEABILITY

FSC 1395

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE
Washington, D. C. 20301

NATO Symbol of Interchangeaiblity
MIL-STD-397

1. This Military Standard is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

2. Recommended corrections, additions, or deletions should be addressed to:

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FOREWARD

The purpose of this new standard is to provide, in a single document, for the implementation of the NATO STANAGs 2315 and 2322 as they pertain to the NATO Symbol of Interchangeability. STANAG's 2315 and 2322 are entitled, respectively "Symbol To Denote The Operational Interchangeability of Ammunition and Demolition Accessories (Short Title: NATO Symbol of Interchangeability" and "Minimum Markings For The Identification of Ammunition (And It's Packaging)".

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CONTENTS

	PAGE
1. SCOPE	1
1.1 Scope	1
1.2 Application	1
2. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS (Not Applicable)	1
3. DEFINITIONS	1
4. REQUIREMENTS	1
4.1 Application	1
4.2 Symbol dimensions and color	1
4.3 Meaning of the symbol	1

FIGURES

FIGURE 1 Symbol Denoting Operational Interchangeability of Ammunition And Demolition Accessories

FIGURE 2 Symbol To Be Used On A Package Containing Ammunition And Accessories

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1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope This standard establishes a symbol to denote operational interchangeability of certain U.S. ammunition or certain U.S. demolition accessories with those of the armed forces of other North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) nations.

1.2 Application

1.2.1 The symbol shall be placed on ammunition, demolition accessory or packagings when prescribed in a NATO agreement, but shall only be placed on an ammunition or demolition accessory which is never put into a package.

1.2.2 When selecting a method of applying the symbol, consideration should be given to the possible necessity of removing or obliterating it, should the ammunition or demolition accessory cease to fulfil, at any time, the conditions implied by the presence of the symbol.

2. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS. (Not Applicable)

3. DEFINITIONS

Operational Interchangeability - Ability to substitute one item for another of different composition or origin without loss in effectiveness, accuracy, and safety of performance.

4. REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Application. The symbol shall be applied as required by the item specification or item packing drawing.

4.2 Symbol Dimensions and Color.

4.2.1 The symbol shall be as indicated in Figure 1. The dimension "H" of the symbol shown in Figure 1 shall be not less than the height nor more than twice the height of the nomenclature marking.

4.2.2 The color of the symbol shall be the same as that of the nomenclature marking.

4.3 Meaning of the Symbol

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4.3.1 In the case of ammunition, the symbol means that the ammunition to which it is applied has been established as conforming as regards its overall dimension, performance and serviceability to a model approved under the provisions laid down in a NATO standardization agreement, brought up to date as necessary. It will therefore be operationally interchangeable with ammunition of the same designation, type and calibre, which bears the same symbol, in all equipment for which such ammunition is normally used.

4.3.2 When in a package containing the ammunition and accessories, such as links and chargers etc., which conform as regard their overall dimensions, performance and serviceability to models approved under the provisions laid down in NATO standardization agreements, the symbol will be enclosed in a square (see Figure 2). All ammunition and accessories contained in packages with the symbol in a square, will be operationally interchangeable in all equipments for which such ammunition and such accessories are normally used.

4.3.3 In the case of a demolition accessory, the symbol means that the accessory has been established as complying with the specifications laid down in a NATO standardization agreement. It will therefore be operationally interchangeable with any accessory of a similar function bearing this symbol, when used in an explosive train made up of elements also bearing this symbol.

5. Certain provisions of this standard are the subject of international standardization agreements, NATO STANAG's 2315 and 2322. When amendments, revision, or cancellation of this standard is proposed which will effect or violate the international agreements concerned, the preparing activity will take appropriate reconciliation action through international standardization channels, including departmental standardization offices, if required.

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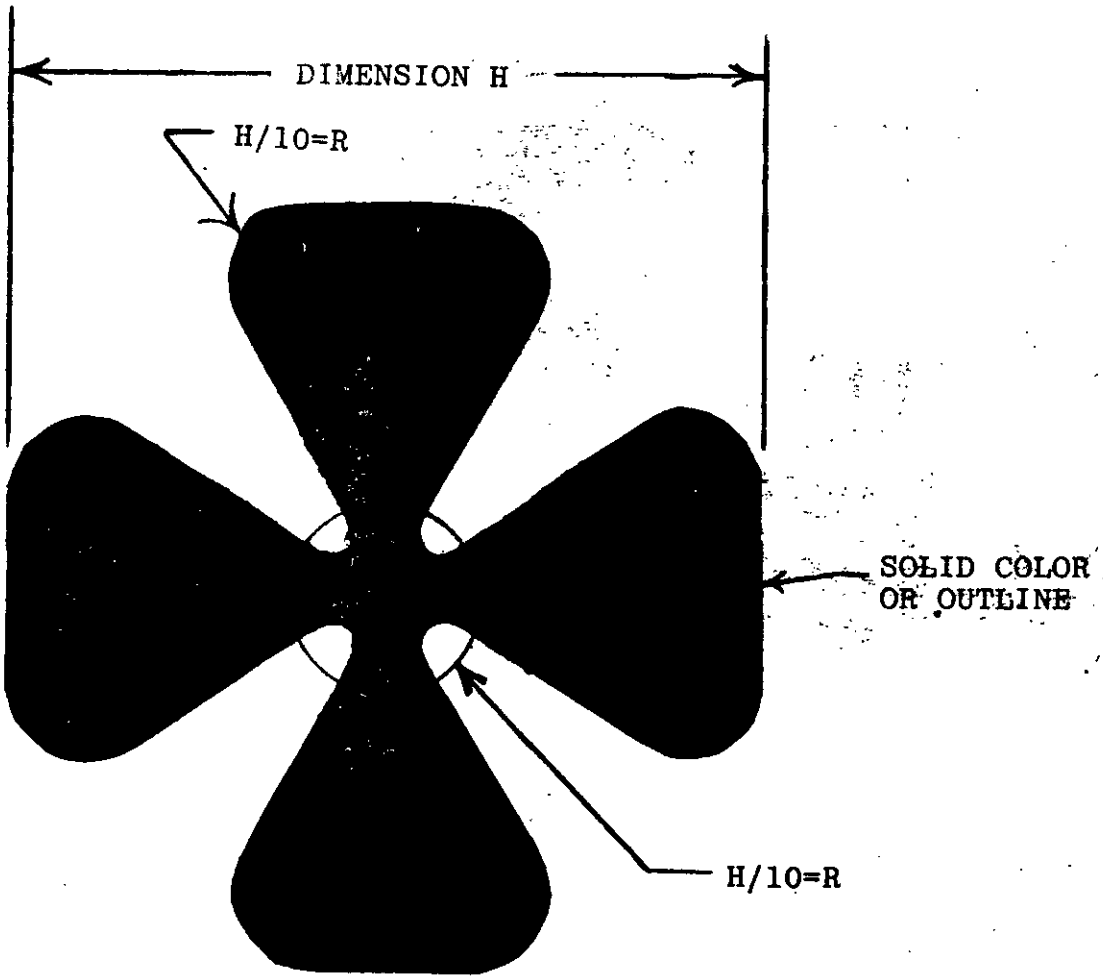


FIGURE 1

SYMBOL DENOTING OPERATIONAL INTERCHANGEABILITY

OF AMMUNITION AND DEMOLITION ACCESSORIES

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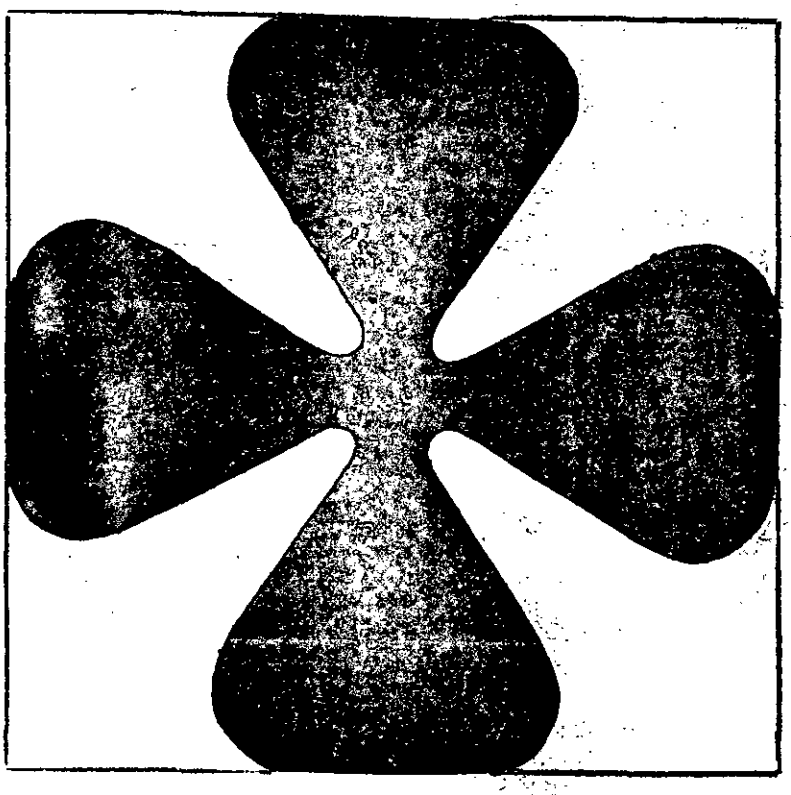


FIGURE 2

SYMBOL TO BE USED ON A PACKAGE CONTAINING

AMMUNITION AND ACCESSORIES

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